

The First Real Deadline: Pressure Builds

第一个真实期限：压力上升

Theme: 求职、职场与职业发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The pressure built **for** a fortnight, **day by day**. The **council** moved the **court** hearing; the **industrial** client added a **charge for** the delay; the **magazine** and the **newspaper** both asked **for** the same interview. “Go back and check the **title**,” the **professional** said. “If the **surface** is wrong, the whole file is wrong.”

A **colleague** in the **gallery** had already written a review, and a **critic** in the same building had written the opposite. “You will **gain credit** with one and lose it with the other,” the **accountant** said. “That is the **margin** you are working in.” The **manufacturer**, the **merchant**, and the **unemployed detective** who shared the **rack** in the corridor all had an opinion.

The **fundamental** problem was **rent**. The office cost more than the **rice** and the **wash** of the whole team, and the **applicant** with the **managerial** experience had already gone away. “Be sure of the question before you answer it,” the **librarian** said. “A **gardener** does not water a **web**.”

The **entrepreneur** in the **sack** coat wanted a **spy** in the opposite team; the **clerical marshal** wanted **lace** on the cover. “Much of this is **occupational** theatre,” Lin said, “and some of it is last-minute panic.” They were already late, and the face of the client on the screen was not a friendly one.

Together the team bought back two days by cutting a **correspondent** from the schedule. “Will it be enough?” Maya asked. “It will be something,” he said, “and something is not nothing.” The old problem returned, as it always did: a **professional** must answer **for** the whole, not **for** the part they touched.

An **insider** from the **newspaper**, a **painter** from the **gallery**, and a **gardener** from the roof came to the office on the last **day**. “The **heart** of the file is the **margin**,” the **insider** said. “Everything else is decoration.” A copy was available on the **rack**, and the man from the **sack** coat read it twice before he bought the **magazine**. The will to continue was there; the time was not. It was already quite dark outside by then.

中文翻译

压力持续了两周，一天接一天。委员会推迟了法庭听证；工业企业客户为延误追加了一笔费用；杂志和报纸都要同一场采访。“回去核对标题，”那位专业人士说，“如果表面是错的，整份文件都是错的。”

画廊里的一位同事已经写了一篇评论，同一栋楼里的一位批评家写了相反的一篇。“你会因此得到一个人的信任，又失去另一个人的，”会计说，“这就是你正在其中工作的余量。”制造商、商人，以及共用走廊那排架子的失业侦探，都有自己的看法。

根本问题是租金。办公室的开销超过整个团队的米饭和洗衣费用，而那位有管理经验的申请人早已离开。“回答问题之前先确定问题，”图书管理员说。“园丁不会给一张网浇水。”

穿麻布外套的企业家想在对手团队里安一个间谍；教士身份的法官想给封面加上花边。“这里面很多是职业性的戏剧，”林伟说，“还有一些是最后一刻的惊慌。”他们已经迟了，而屏幕上客户的脸并不友善。

团队一起从日程里砍掉一名通讯记者，换回了三天。“这够吗？”曼雅问。“总算是点东西，”他说，“而点东西不是没有。”那个老问题又回来了，一如既往：专业人士必须为整体负责，而不只是为自己碰过的那部分。

最后一天，来自报社的一位内部人士、来自画廊的一位画家，以及来自屋顶的一位园丁来到办公室。“这份文件的核心是那处空白，”内部人士说，“其他都是装饰。”架子上有一份可取的副本，穿麻布外套的那个人读了它两遍，才买下那本杂志。继续下去的意志还在，时间不在。外面已经黑了。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
for fɔː POS: prep	prep. 为, 因为, 至于; conj. 因为; [计] DOS批处理命令:对一组参数重复执行指定的命令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. In the most general sense, indicating that in consideration; of, in view of, or with reference to, wh...
go gou POS: vi	vi. 去, 走, 达到, 运转, 查阅, 消失, 结束, 放弃, 花费, 流传, 趋于, 打算, 剩下; vt. 以...打赌, 对付... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a time for working (after which you will be relieved by someone else); n. a board game for two players who...
day dei POS: n	n. 天, 日子, 白天, 工作日; [医] 日(一昼夜), 昼, 白天 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. time for Earth to make a complete rotation on its axis; n. some point or period in time; n. a day assigned t...
move muːv POS: n	n. 移动, 迁居, 步骤; vt. 移动, 开动, 感动, 搬(家); vi. 移动, 离开, 运行, 迁移, 摇动, 搬家, 交往, 进展... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of deciding to do something; n. the act of changing your residence or place of business; n. (game) a...
council 'kaunsəl POS: n	n. 会议, 委员会; [经] 委员会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a body serving in an administrative capacity; n. (Christianity) an assembly of theologians and bishops and...
court kɔ:t POS: n	n. 法院, 庭院, 奉承; vt. 献殷勤, 追求, 招致; vi. 求爱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an assembly (including one or more judges) to conduct judicial business; n. a room in which a lawcourt sits...
heart hɑ:t POS: n	n. 心, 心脏, 中心, 内心, 感情, 精神, 心情, 宝贝儿; vt. 鼓励 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the locus of feelings and intuitions; n. the hollow muscular organ located behind the sternum and between t...
charge tʃɑ:dʒ POS: n	n. 指控, 费用, 冲锋, 电荷, 炸药, 主管, 被托管人, 命令; vt. 控诉, 加罪于, 使充满, 使充电, 使承担; vi. 冲锋... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an impetuous rush toward someone or something; n. (criminal law) a pleading describing some wrong or offens...
title 'taɪtl POS: n	n. 头衔, 名称, 标题, 书名, 扉页, 权利, 资格, 冠军, 字幕; vt. 授予头衔, 加标题于; [计] 标题 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a heading that names a statute or legislative bill; may give a brief summary of the matters it deals with; ...
industrial in'dʌstriəl POS: a	a. 工业的, 供工业用的, 工业高度发展的, 产业的; n. 工业工人, 工业股票 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or resulting from industry; a. having highly developed industries; s. employed in industry...
professional prə'feʃənəl POS: n	n. 专业人才; a. 专业的, 职业的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person engaged in one of the learned professions; n. an athlete who plays for pay; a. engaged in a profess...
surface 'sə:fɪs POS: n	n. 面, 表面, 水面, 外表, 平面; a. 表面的, 外观的, 肤浅的, 水面上的; vt. 使成平面, 使浮出水面; vi. 浮出水面... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the outer boundary of an artifact or a material layer constituting or resembling such a boundary; n. the ex...
magazine 'mæɡə'zi:n POS: n	n. 杂志, 仓库, 弹盒, 胶卷盒; [计] 卡片箱, 介质装卸程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a periodic publication containing pictures and stories and articles of interest to those who purchase it o...
newspaper 'nju:z.peɪpə POS: n	n. 报纸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements; n. a busines...
gain geɪn POS: n	n. 增益, 获得, 利润, 收获, 增加; vt. 得到, 增进, 赚到; vi. 获利, 增加; [计] 增益 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the amount by which the revenue of a business exceeds its cost of operating; v. obtain advantages, such as...
credit 'kredit POS: n	n. 信用, 信任, 荣誉, 贷款, 学分; vt. 归功于, 赞颂, 信任, 相信; [计] 信用量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. money available for a client to borrow; n. an accounting entry acknowledging income or capital items; n. use...
colleague 'kɒli:g POS: n	n. 同事, 同僚 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an associate that one works with; n. a person who is member of one's class or profession
critic 'kritik POS: n	n. 批评家, 鉴定家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is professionally engaged in the analysis and interpretation of works of art; n. anyone who ex...
gallery 'gæləri POS: n	n. 走廊, 最高楼座, 画廊, 收集, 图库; [计] 图库 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. spectators at a golf or tennis match; n. a room or series of rooms where works of art are exhibited; n. a lo...

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wash wɒʃ POS: n	n. 洗, 洗涤, 冲洗, 洗的衣服, 冲积物, 洼地; vt. 洗, 洗涤, 洗清, 用水冲洗, 流过, 弄湿, 粉刷, 镀金属薄层于; v... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a thin coat of water-base paint; n. the work of cleansing (usually with soap and water); n. the dry bed of a...
manufacturer ˌmænjʊˈfæktʃərə POS: n	n. 制造业者, 厂商; [经] 制造人, 制造商, 制造厂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a business engaged in manufacturing some product; n. someone who manufactures something
fundamental ˌfʌndəˈmentəl POS: n	n. 基本原理, 原则, 基波; a. 基本的, 重要的, 原音的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any factor that could be considered important to the understanding of a particular business; n. the lowest...
rent rent POS: n	n. 租金, 房租, 出租物, 裂缝, 破裂处, 分裂; vt. 租用, 租出; vi. 出租; a. 分裂的, 破裂的; rend的过去式和过去... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a payment or series of payments made by the lessee to an owner for use of some property, facility, equipment...
rice rais POS: n	n. 米, 米饭, 稻; vt. 将...压成米粒状 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. grains used as food either unpolished or more often polished; n. annual or perennial rhizomatous marsh grass...
merchant ˈmɜːtʃənt POS: n	n. 商人, 店主; a. 商业的, 商人的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a businessperson engaged in retail trade
unemployed ˌʌnɪmˈplɔɪd POS: a	a. 失业的, 未被利用的; [经] 没有被雇用的, 失业的, 没有被利用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not engaged in a gainful occupation
detective dɪˈtektɪv POS: n	n. 侦探; a. 侦探的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a police officer who investigates crimes; n. an investigator engaged or employed in obtaining information n...
correspondent ˌkɒrɪˈspɒndənt POS: n	n. 通讯记者, 通信者; [经] 客户, 代理商行, 代理银行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who communicates by means of letters; n. a journalist employed to provide news stories for newspaper...
margin ˈmɑːdʒɪn POS: n	n. 页边的空白, 边缘, 界限, 余裕, 差数, 差额, 保证金; vt. 加边于, 加旁注于; [计] 页边距 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the boundary line or the area immediately inside the boundary; n. an amount beyond the minimum necessary; n. ...
applicant ˈæplɪkənt POS: n	n. 申请者; [经] 申请人, 请求人, 谋事人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who requests or seeks something such as assistance or employment or admission
accountant əˈkaʊntənt POS: n	n. 会计人员, 会计师; [经] 会计师, 会计人员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who maintains and audits business accounts
painter ˈpeɪntə POS: n	n. 画家, 油漆匠; [机] 油漆匠, 喷漆匠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an artist who paints; n. a worker who is employed to cover objects with paint; n. a line that is attached to...
web web POS: n	n. 网, 蛛丝, 蹊, 织物, 圈套, 卷筒纸; vi. 结网, 形成网; vt. 织蜘蛛网于, 使落入圈套 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an intricate network suggesting something that was formed by weaving or interweaving; n. an intricate trap...
occupational ˌɒkjʊˈpeɪʃənl POS: a	a. 职业的, 军事占领的; [医] 职业的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to the activity or business for which you are trained
rack ræk POS: n	n. 架, 行李架, 饲草架, 搁物架, 痛苦, 折磨, 齿条, 行云团; vt. 把...放在架上, 在架上制作, 折磨, 使痛苦, 压榨... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. framework for holding objects; n. rib section of a forequarter of veal or pork or especially lamb or mutton...
entrepreneur ˌɒntrəˈprəʊnəː POS: n	n. 企业家, 主办人; [经] 承包商, 企业家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who organizes a business venture and assumes the risk for it
sack sæk POS: n	n. 麻布袋, 洗劫; vt. 把...装入袋, 洗劫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a bag made of paper or plastic for holding customer's purchases; n. the quantity contained in a sack; n. any...
librarian laɪˈbrɛəriən POS: n	n. 图书馆员, 图书管理员; [计] 程序库管理程序; 程序库生成程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a professional person trained in library science and engaged in library services
gardener ˈgɑːdənə POS: n	n. 园丁, 花匠, 园艺家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who takes care of a garden; n. someone employed to work in a garden
spy spai POS: n	n. 间谍, 侦探, 侦察; vt. 侦察, 找出, 发现; vi. 做密探, 侦查 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (military) a secret agent hired by a state to obtain information about its enemies or by a business to obt...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
lace leɪs POS: n	n. 饰带, 花边, 缎带, 鞋带; vt. 结带子, 饰以花边; vi. 系带子; [计] 全穿孔 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a cord that is drawn through eyelets or around hooks in order to draw together two edges (as of a shoe or...)
managerial ˌmænəˈdʒɪəriəl POS: a	a. 管理的; [经] 管理上的, 经营上的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to the function or responsibility or activity of management
insider ˈɪnˈsaɪdə POS: n	n. 内部的人, 权威人士, 知道内情的人; [经] 熟悉内情者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an officer of a corporation or others who have access to private information about the corporation's opera...
clerical ˈklerɪkəl POS: n	n. 牧师; a. 文书的, 事务上的, 抄写员的, 牧师的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to clerks; a. of or relating to the clergy; s. appropriate for or engaged in office work
marshal ˈmɑːʃəl POS: n	n. 元帅, 陆空军高级将官, 典礼官, 执法官; vt. 整理, 引领, 统率; vi. 排列, 各就各位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a law officer having duties similar to those of a sheriff in carrying out the judgments of a court of law; ...